Sponsorship disclosure and consumer skepticism

Abstract. A 2 (disclosure: yes vs. no) x 2 (source: influencer vs. brand) between-subjects experiment tested how sponsorship disclosure shapes consumer skepticism. H1: Disclosure increases skepticism. H2: The effect is stronger for influencers. Method. Participants were recruited on Prolific and randomly assigned to one of four conditions. Of 456 participants, 36 failed the attention check, leaving 420. The manipulation check was successful. We analysed the data with two-way ANOVA.

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Table 1. Consumer skepticism by condition

Disclosure	Source	M	SD	n
yes	influencer	5.12	1.10	106
yes	brand	4.61	1.21	104
no	influencer	4.02	1.15	105
no	brand	3.95	1.18	105

Results. Disclosure increased skepticism, F(1, 416) = 18.20, p < .001, partial eta squared = .04, supporting H1.

The disclosure x source interaction was significant, F(1, 416) = 4.10, p = .043, supporting H2.

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Discussion. Disclosure raises skepticism, especially for influencers.

A limitation is the single product category used in the stimuli.

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